APPROVED ON NOVEMBER 4, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION – October 28, 2026
9:00 a.m. - Anne G. Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron A. Smith, Chair; Colene M. Martin, Vice-Chair; Gary L. Richardson, Commissioner; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:05 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:

Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

PUBLIC HEARING:

a. Second Public Hearing – 2024 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Program H24007 – Close-out of the Josephine County Home Repair & Rehabilitation Program

Chair Smith opened the public hearing at 9:06 a.m. Heléne Lulich, Real Property Manager, Office of Legal Counsel, presented the required second public hearing for close-out of the 2024 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Home Repair & Rehabilitation Program, H24007. Lulich explained that the grant was complete and the hearing was required before the County could close the project and proceed with its next grant award. She reported that the program began assisting residents in February 2025 and read a letter from a Cave Junction-area homeowner expressing appreciation for the County and Home Bridging GP after the program replaced a deteriorated roof and improved the home.

Austin Hansen, Home Bridging GP, presented program results (Exhibit 1). He reported that 21 homes occupied by 29 residents were assisted, all qualifying as low- to moderate-income households, with more than $420,000 invested in home repairs. Nine of the homes were manufactured homes located in mobile home parks. Work completed included windows and doors, wells, accessibility ramps, structural/seismic work, gutters, septic repairs and tank replacements, and 13 roof replacements. Hansen stated that local contractors performed the work, federal program requirements were met, and a substantial waiting list already exists for the next grant cycle. Public testimony was then received.

Deb Berg, Josephine County, identified additional manufactured-home parks in the County and expressed appreciation for the repair work, encouraging continued outreach to eligible residents in those communities.

Mark Jones, Josephine County, stated that several manufactured-home parks in the County contain homes in need of repair. He encouraged broader promotion of the program and consideration of additional qualified organizations that could become subgrantees and perform rehabilitation work in future grant cycles.

Debbie Richmond, Josephine County, praised the program and suggested that public property at the Fairgrounds could also be considered in broader discussions regarding subsidized or low-income housing opportunities.

Eva Avery, Grants Pass, stated that she had not previously known about the program and described the needs of residents in her 55-and-older manufactured-home community. She encouraged additional outreach to manufactured-home residents and raised concerns about increasing space rents. Lulich responded that the CDBG repair program does not regulate space rents; organizations interested in participating may seek qualification through Business Oregon as subgrantees; and County grant funds may serve eligible properties outside the City of Grants Pass because the City receives its own HUD funding directly.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the close-out of the 2024 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Program H24007, Josephine County Home Repair & Rehabilitation Program. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Chair Smith closed the public hearing at 9:24 a.m.

ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION(S) IN CONSIDERATION OF:

a. Order No. 2026-061 – In the Matter of the Regular Weekly Business Meeting of the Board of County Commissioners for the Date of November 25, 2026

The Board introduced Order No. 2026-061, canceling the regular Weekly Business Session scheduled for November 25, 2026 because a Board quorum would not be available in Josephine County that day. Formal action was taken after citizen comments and Board responses.

REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS:

Eva Avery, Grants Pass, spoke about civic engagement and the Braver Angels urban-rural discussion held the prior evening. She encouraged greater participation in public meetings and elections, described her experience observing election procedures, and expressed confidence in Oregon's vote-by-mail system and election-security processes.

Brett Hopper, Josephine County, raised concerns regarding operations and public communication at the Josephine County airports (Exhibit 2). He discussed Airport Advisory Board participation, access to airport management, unanswered questions from airport users, and the Grants Pass Airport weather-system outage. He stated that the outage had delayed reactivation of instrument approach and departure procedures and emphasized the potential effect on air ambulance, commercial, and fire-response aviation operations.

Deb Berg, Josephine County, submitted photographs concerning the Harris Creek gate at the Grants Pass Airport (Exhibit 3). She stated that the gate had remained open and could allow deer, elk, bear, and other wildlife onto airport property and the runway area. She urged the County to address the gate as a low-cost safety measure and also described Brett Hopper's aviation experience and involvement with the airport community.

Mark Jones, Josephine County, expressed concern about the reported wildlife hazard at the airport based on his prior aircraft-rescue firefighting experience. He also noted that ODF had declared fire season over and thanked local fire districts, ODF, federal agencies, and mutual-aid partners for their work during the 2026 fire season.

Debbie Richmond, Josephine County, thanked the Board for addressing previously raised concerns regarding fire extinguishers at the Josephine County Fairgrounds racetrack barns.

BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:

Commissioner Richardson discussed Oregon voter-registration records and explained that only active voters receive ballots. He encouraged residents who receive a ballot for a former resident to mark it return to sender so the Clerk can begin the statutory address-verification process. He stated that the airport concerns raised by Mr. Hopper required additional review and would be followed up on, and he thanked fire agencies for their work and ongoing wildfire preparedness efforts.

Commissioner Martin thanked the public for bringing concerns directly to the Board and stated that the airport issues raised were concerning and would be reviewed. She also explained that the County Clerk had changed to a secure ballot envelope that eliminated the separate secrecy sleeve and was expected to save approximately $28,000 per election. Martin acknowledged the end of fire season while encouraging continued caution until conditions were fully wet.

Chair Smith stated that he shared concerns regarding matters at the airport that were beyond the ability of an individual Commissioner to resolve and praised ODF and other first responders for their rapid response throughout the fire season, which helped Josephine County avoid a major smoke-filled summer.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Order No. 2026-061, In the Matter of the Regular Weekly Business Meeting of the Board of County Commissioners for the Date of November 25, 2026, canceling the November 25, 2026 Weekly Business Session. Commissioner Richardson seconded. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:

Minutes: Admin Workshop – October 20, 2026; Weekly Business Session – October 21, 2026; EMS Advisory Committee – July 8, 2026; Fair Board – September 15, 2026.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the Consent Calendar as presented. Commissioner Martin seconded. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

OTHER MATTERS: (ORS 192.640(1) "...notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.")

None heard.

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

a. Juvenile Justice Program Data and Information

Commissioner Richardson highlighted new Juvenile Justice program data and graphics published on the County website. He explained that the information shows community-service hours, the number of youth served through the 14-bed detention center over the course of a year, and the broader counseling, skill-building, and support services provided to youth who are not housed in detention. He said the purpose of publishing the data was to help the public better understand the scope of the County's Juvenile Justice work.

Chair Smith praised the Juvenile Justice Department as a model for other Oregon counties and thanked staff for their work. Commissioner Martin also recognized Director Scott Hyde and the department for maintaining services during recent County transitions. Martin announced that the Oregon geological service, in coordination with the U.S. Geological Survey, would present information regarding Josephine County's geological and mineral potential on Friday, October 30, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. in the Anne G. Basker Auditorium. Commissioner Richardson again thanked first responders for the successful fire season.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:51 a.m.

Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Exhibit 1- PowerPoint from Home Repair and Rehabilitation

Exhibit 2 – Brett Hopper

Exhibit 3 – Deb Berg

Weekly Business Session
10-28-2026
Exhibit 1

A COMMUNITY SUCCESS STORY

2024 Home Repair & Rehabilitation Program

Josephine County · CDBG Grant H24007

21 homes restored · 29 residents kept safely housed · 100% low-to-moderate income

Administered by Home Bridging GP, Inc. | Funded through Business Oregon (CDBG / IFA)

Program at a glance

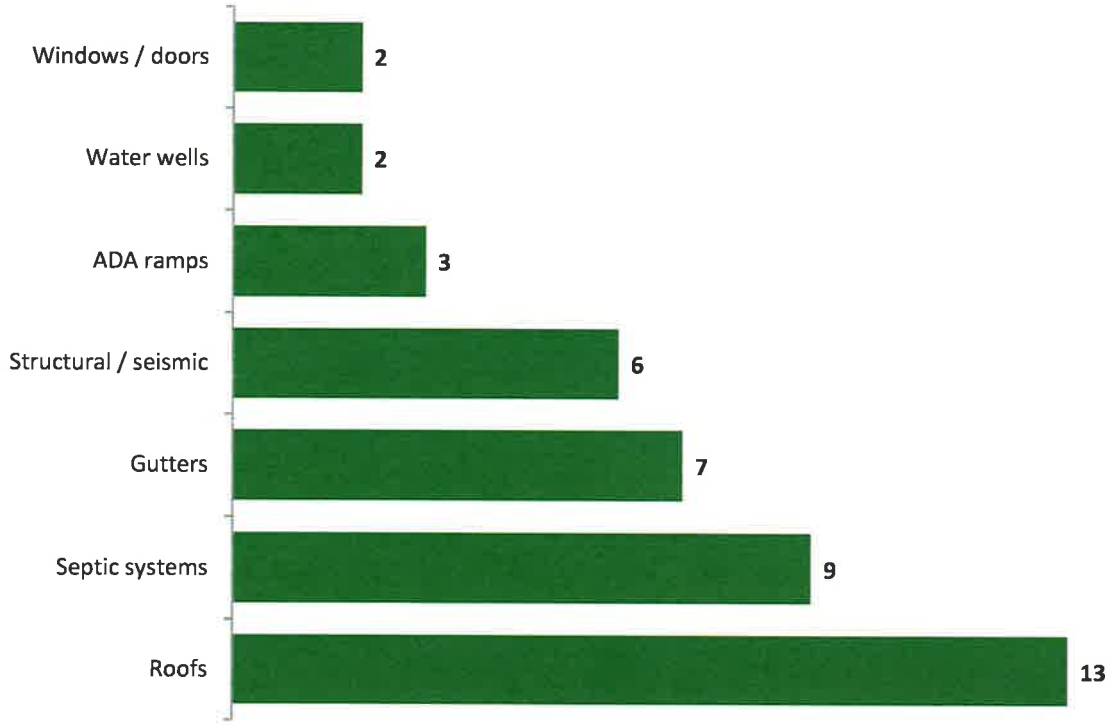
Every assisted household verified at or below 80% of area median income

21	29	100%	$420K	9
Homes rehabilitated	Residents helped	Low/mod income	CDBG invested	Mobile homes

The program is complete, fully monitored, and ready to close out with Business Oregon.

What we built

Roofs and septic systems were the backbone — many homes combined several trades



3 full septic-tank replacements

2 seismic tie-downs for mobile homes

2 water wells restored

Who we served

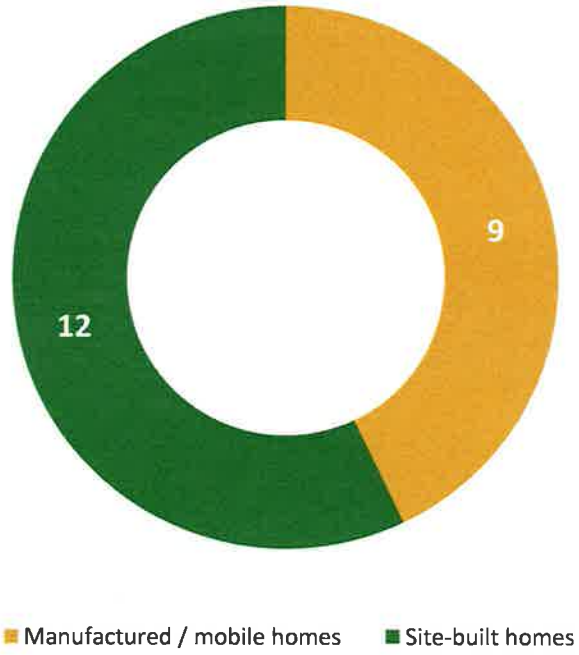
Reaching the county's most vulnerable homeowners

100%	Low- and moderate-income households — all verified at or below 80% AMI
29	Residents across 21 households kept safely in their homes
2 in 3	Households with a senior homeowner, age 62+ (14 of 21)
County-wide	Grants Pass, Selma, and Cave Junction

Homeowners as old as 81 — many living on fixed incomes from Social Security, VA disability, and pensions.

Preserving affordable housing

Nearly half the program protected manufactured homes — the hardest stock to replace



9 of 21 homes (~43%)

were manufactured / mobile homes

- **222 Ollis Road mobile-home park — 7 homes**
- **5076 Leonard Road mobile-home park — 2 homes**

Including 2 seismic tie-downs

- **Every home built after 1976**

Manufactured homes had to be built after 1976 to qualify — the year HUD's federal construction and safety code took effect

Responsible stewardship & local impact

Full federal compliance

- ✓ Income eligibility verified for every household (HUD limits)
- ✓ Environmental reviews — site-specific (Tier 2) and SHPO / Section 106 clearances
- ✓ Lead-based paint requirements addressed on each project
- ✓ Housing Quality Standard (HQS) inspections performed
- ✓ Contractor warranties and lien waivers obtained at close-out
- ✓ Monitoring checklist completed to document compliance

Local dollars, local jobs

- $420,000 in CDBG funds invested across the 21 homes
- Work performed by local contractors and trades — roofing, septic, excavation, gutters, and well service
- Federal dollars recirculated directly in the Josephine County economy

Ready to close out

A successful program, delivered and documented

✓ Accept the program completion report

✓ Authorize the final close-out and final draw to Business Oregon

✓ Recognize a program that kept 29 vulnerable, low-income residents safely housed

Thank you.

Weekly Business Session 10/28/26 Exhibit 2

Gmail

Brett Hopper <piperapache@gmail.com>

Questions from Airports Board meeting on 8-4-2026

1 message

Brett Hopper <piperapache@gmail.com> Mon, Aug 10, 2026 at 12:45 PM
To: Michael Crisafulli <MCrisafulli@josephinecounty.gov>

On August 4th an airports board meeting took place. With no county representatives present the following questions were formally/motioned for me to ask.

- Is the GP compass rose certified?
- Are monthly weather machine checks being done?
- The board motions to have the county update all supplemental chart data, add Alfa Bravo labeling, taxiway signage, and runway remaining as well as update runup area signage
- Remind county regarding commitment to remove chains in blocking parking space in approved area for parking on IV
- Ask for explanation for missed meetings by county workers
- Motion- JoCo county should publish lease rates, and requirements in a timely manner
- Ask what is involved in getting a Noaa approved weather machine in IV that will report to Aviation weather center

Please get these answers back to me and I'll make sure the board is informed.

Brett Hopper
Vice Chair JoCo airports Board.

Gmail

Brett Hopper <piperapache@gmail.com>

Consern regarding Airport Weather machine at the Grants Pass Airport

1 message

Brett Hopper <piperapache@gmail.com> Thu, Jul 9, 2026 at 8:28 AM
To: Gary Richardson <Grichardson@josephinecounty.gov>, cmartin@josephinecounty.gov, Ron Smith <RSmith@josephinecounty.gov>, Michael Crisafulli <MCrisafulli@josephinecounty.gov>

To: Josephine County Officials

I have concern over the Grants Pass airport's weather reporting machine being out of service. This outage has persisted for 7 days. With no communication from the County my concern grows. There has been one previous outage with the current management, at that time it was said "If I was worried about the weather system being out I could place the NOTAM myself", I am glad to see a NOTAM has been issued without my involvement. Please repair it quickly as the following is considered:

- This outage happened July 2nd and there has been no communications regarding this from Josephine County.
- This outage, coupled with the Airport Management's decision to remove public webcams has effectively removed all outbound information to the flying public. For 1 week there has been no current meteorological information regarding Grants Pass available for flight planning or for Air Traffic Control use.
- Similar to changing when the runway will be open or closed, prior airport administrators have done a more timely job of informing our airport population.
- The METAR reports this machine generates for NOAA and the FAA serve as the cornerstone for how pilots evaluate airports and serves as a foundation for the Go/NoGo decision making process pilots are legally required to make.
- The Grants Pass Airport is part of the National Airspace System, I urge you to maintain the basic functions that have been established.
- The RNAV 13 instrument Approach and Obstacle Departure are currently deactivated and a flight check is pending at great expense, I worry the lack of AWOS weather information will delay this process further or trigger the need for a re-test (increasing cost) as it is required for this instrument approach.
- It is Josephine counties responsibility to maintain this machine.

Brett Hopper

Department Lead - Rocketman LLC

541-441-1841

Federal Aviation Administration

!FDC 6/3212 3S8 IAP GRANTS PASS, GRANTS PASS, OR.
RNAV (GPS) RWY 13, AMDT 1A...
PROCEDURE NA.
2607062031-2702152031EST

!FDC 6/3214 3S8 ODP GRANTS PASS, GRANTS PASS, OR.
TAKEOFF MINIMUMS AND (OBSTACLE) DEPARTURE PROCEDURES AMDT 1...
DEPARTURE PROCEDURE RWY 31 NA.
2607062031-2702152031EST

!MMV 08/021 3S8 RWY 13 RWY END ID LGT U/S 2608031859-2611032359

!MMV 10/036 3S8 TWY A NORTHWEST 300FT CLSD 2610122200-2610311300

!MMV 10/037 3S8 TWY A5 CLSD 2610122200-2610311300

!MMV 10/091 3S8 RWY 13/31 CLSD 2610280001-2610281300

!FDC 6/2993 3S8 ODP GRANTS PASS, GRANTS PASS, OR.
TAKEOFF MINIMUMS AND (OBSTACLE) DEPARTURE PROCEDURES AMDT 1...
DEPARTURE PROCEDURE NA EXCEPT FOR ACFT EQUIPPED WITH SUITABLE RNAV SYSTEM WITH GPS, RBG VOR/DME OUT OF SERVICE. 2610281630-2610282355EST

-----End of PDF Report.-----

This content is from the eCFR and is authoritative but unofficial.

Displaying title 14, up to date as of 10/26/2026. Title 14 was last amended 10/15/2026.

Title 14 —Aeronautics and Space
Chapter I —Federal Aviation Administration, Department of Transportation
Subchapter G —Air Carriers and Operators for Compensation or Hire: Certification and Operations
Part 135
—Operating Requirements: Commuter and on Demand Operations and Rules Governing Persons on Board Such Aircraft
Subpart D —VFR/IFR Operating Limitations and Weather Requirements

§ 135.225 IFR: Takeoff, approach and landing minimums.

(a) Except to the extent permitted by paragraphs (b) and (j) of this section, no pilot may begin an instrument approach procedure to an airport unless—

(1) That airport has a weather reporting facility operated by the U.S. National Weather Service, a source approved by U.S. National Weather Service, or a source approved by the Administrator; and

(2) The latest weather report issued by that weather reporting facility indicates that weather conditions are at or above the authorized IFR landing minimums for that airport.

(b) A pilot conducting an eligible on-demand operation may begin and conduct an instrument approach procedure to an airport that does not have a weather reporting facility operated by the U.S. National Weather Service, a source approved by the U.S. National Weather Service, or a source approved by the Administrator if—

(1) The alternate airport has a weather reporting facility operated by the U.S. National Weather Service, a source approved by the U.S. National Weather Service, or a source approved by the Administrator; and

(2) The latest weather report issued by the weather reporting facility includes a current local altimeter setting for the destination airport. If no local altimeter setting for the destination airport is available, the pilot may use the current altimeter setting provided by the facility designated on the approach chart for the destination airport.

(c) Except as provided in paragraph (j) of this section, no pilot may begin the final approach segment of an instrument approach procedure to an airport unless the latest weather reported by the facility described in paragraph (a)(1) of this section indicates that weather conditions are at or above the authorized IFR landing minimums for that procedure.

(d) Except as provided in paragraph (j) of this section, a pilot who has begun the final approach segment of an instrument approach to an airport under paragraph (c) of this section, and receives a later weather report indicating that conditions have worsened to below the minimum requirements, may continue the approach only if the following conditions are met—

(1) The later weather report is received when the aircraft is in one of the following approach phases:

(i) The aircraft is on an ILS final approach and has passed the final approach fix;

(ii) The aircraft is on an ASR or PAR final approach and has been turned over to the final approach controller; or

(iii) The aircraft is on a non-precision final approach and the aircraft—

(A) Has passed the appropriate facility or final approach fix; or

(B) Where a final approach fix is not specified, has completed the procedure turn and is established inbound toward the airport on the final approach course within the distance prescribed in the procedure; and

(2) The pilot in command finds, on reaching the authorized MDA or DA/DH, that the actual weather conditions are at or above the minimums prescribed for the procedure being used.

(e) The MDA or DA/DH and visibility landing minimums prescribed in part 97 of this chapter or in the operator's operations specifications are increased by 100 feet and $^1/_2$ mile respectively, but not to exceed the ceiling and visibility minimums for that airport when used as an alternate airport, for each pilot in command of a turbine-powered airplane who has not served at least 100 hours as pilot in command in that type of airplane.

(f) Each pilot making an IFR takeoff or approach and landing at a military or foreign airport shall comply with applicable instrument approach procedures and weather minimums prescribed by the authority having jurisdiction over that airport. In addition, unless authorized by the certificate holder's operations specifications, no pilot may, at that airport—

(1) Take off under IFR when the visibility is less than 1 mile; or

(2) Make an instrument approach when the visibility is less than $^1/_2$ mile.

(g) If takeoff minimums are specified in part 97 of this chapter for the take- off airport, no pilot may take off an aircraft under IFR when the weather conditions reported by the facility described in paragraph (a)(1) of this section are less than the takeoff minimums specified for the takeoff airport in part 97 or in the certificate holder's operations specifications.

(h) Except as provided in paragraph (i) of this section, if takeoff minimums are not prescribed in part 97 of this chapter for the takeoff airport, no pilot may takeoff an aircraft under IFR when the weather conditions reported by the facility described in paragraph (a)(1) of this section are less than that prescribed in part 91 of this chapter or in the certificate holder's operations specifications.

(i) At airports where straight-in instrument approach procedures are authorized, a pilot may takeoff an aircraft under IFR when the weather conditions reported by the facility described in paragraph (a)(1) of this section are equal to or better than the lowest straight-in landing minimums, unless otherwise restricted, if—

(1) The wind direction and velocity at the time of takeoff are such that a straight-in instrument approach can be made to the runway served by the instrument approach;

(2) The associated ground facilities upon which the landing minimums are predicated and the related airborne equipment are in normal operation; and

(3) The certificate holder has been approved for such operations.

(j) A pilot may begin an instrument approach procedure, or continue an approach, at an airport when the visibility is reported to be less than the visibility minimums prescribed for that procedure if the pilot uses an operable EFVS in accordance with § 91.176 of this chapter and the certificate holder's operations specifications for EFVS operations.

[Docket 16097, 43 FR 46783, Oct. 10, 1978, as amended by Amdt. 135-91, 68 FR 54586, Sept. 17, 2003; Amdt. 135-93, 69 FR 1641, Jan. 9, 2004; Amdt. 135-110, 72 FR 31685, June 7, 2007; Amdt. 135-126, 77 FR 1632, Jan. 11, 2012; Docket FAA-2013-0485, Amdt. 135-135, 81 FR 90177, Dec. 13, 2016]

Weekly Business Session
10/28/26
Exhibit 3

